



The Altenburg Foundation Newsletter

JULY 2026



Working for
education,
integration
& maximum
community
impact

Dear Friends

I hope you are all well and looking forward to a wonderful summer holiday—perhaps somewhere a little cooler this year, as we've already had a taste of the heat.

I'm delighted to share something very close to my heart. In May, we launched our new Fellowship Programme, supporting exceptionally talented scholars from crisis-affected regions.

Over the past few months, I've had the privilege of meeting many of these remarkable young people, all of whom have overcome extraordinary challenges with courage & determination. Despite everything they have experienced, they remain deeply committed to improving lives in their home communities through work in healthcare, education, justice & social development. You will see on page 2 how our Fellowship aims to help them build on these efforts.

We are also looking to support them with one particular practical challenge: finding temporary accommodation as they settle into life in London. This is where our community can make a real difference.

If you have a spare room available for a few weeks or months, you could offer much more than a place to stay. You would be welcoming someone with an extraordinary story, valuable expertise and a genuine desire to learn, contribute and connect. Hosting can be equally rewarding, offering new perspectives and meaningful cultural exchange—something that feels more important than ever in today's world.

There are many other ways to help, of course. You might choose to mentor a Fellow, make introductions, provide financial support or simply share our mission with others. Every contribution helps create opportunities for people who have overcome immense challenges.

I hope you enjoy following the journeys of our Fellows in the months ahead. Please do get in touch if you have any questions or suggestions.

Enjoy a lovely summer!

Christiane



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Building on the work undertaken last year, we are thrilled to announce the establishment of our **Fellowship Programme**. This initiative now forms the key pillar of the work of the Altenburg Foundation, offering a structured support pathway for refugees and at-risk professionals from Sudan and Palestine. The scheme provides tailored support for postgraduate academics with language and professional exams, enabling them to regain or continue their careers in the UK.



In addition to financial support with academic re-accreditation, the programme offers practical assistance in the UK, including guidance and connections to secure appropriate accommodation and employment opportunities, before fellows have fully completed their UK equivalency processes.

The scheme will also extend to fellows' initiatives in their home countries, supporting their projects that strengthen health, education, justice, and community resilience in conflict-affected areas. Through a combination of professional development, social and cultural activities, and targeted project support, the programme aims to cultivate a cohort of leaders who contribute to the UK workforce and to long-term rebuilding in their countries of origin.

Our pilot cohort of seven fellows is drawn from professional fields including medicine, business, AI & data science, and education.



Thanks to the generosity of the London Philharmonia we were able to attend four wonderful concerts with a large group of scholars.

As well as individual support, the group has also so far participated in networking events tailored to them obtaining mentors and support for their projects back home, concerts at the Philharmonia Orchestra, informative meetings with immigration lawyers, social lunches and dinners, and beautiful walks around London. We are very excited to see what this Fellowship Programme, and of course the amazing Fellows themselves, will go on to achieve.

Uganda



P4T

With the unfolding crisis in DR Congo and Uganda, we have supported our partner P4T in securing funds for ebola readiness and prevention.



We are so grateful that this has resulted in our colleagues at Belron Ronnie Lubner Charitable Foundation providing emergency funds which cover PPE, handwashing facilities and other measures not only for the P4Ts schools and clinic but also for other schools in Kyangwali, which will be supported through P4T.

We have also worked with P4T to prepare a successful bid for construction of the much-needed dormitory accommodation for 160 learners at their secondary school.

BRLCF has generously funded this vital project, which will enable learners to safely and securely continue with their studies, even though they may live significantly far away. Work will be undertaken over the coming months, and we look forward to updating you on the progress.



Lebanon

Alsama

We were absolutely thrilled that Alsama, one of our partners in Lebanon, has been named the winner of the Varkey Foundation's inaugural Global Schools Prize, an award which showcases the world's most innovative and impactful schools reimagining education for the future.



The \$500,000 prize will allow them to scale up their operations.

The Altenburg Foundation has funded their pathway cohort during these last years to enable them to complete their secondary-level education against a backdrop of huge barriers to learning, not least of which has been the conflicts in 2024 and this year. It is truly wonderful that this initial group is now graduating from the programme we supported with exceptionally high levels of academic achievement, recognised by some of the learners earning scholarships to the University of Cambridge, the University of Leicester, and Arizona State University. Well done to all!



Tuyoor al Amal

We are continuing to work with our friends at Tuyoor al Amal to plan for the opening of their school in Syria, following their hugely successful model in Tripoli. Although things never seem to move as quickly as we would like, it is of course crucial to make certain that the next steps are secure and stable, and that they will be able to deliver the best possible quality in this time of renewal.

Malawi

We are delighted to announce that the Altenburg Foundation has renewed its support to our partners **Mayankho** in Malawi for a further two years. With our support, this wonderful organisation, a “learning institution that learns”, has so far helped four cohorts of entrepreneurs to establish and develop their business through a combination of business skills training and micro-finance.



Our continuing partnership will allow the team to maintain its core operations, strengthen their loan recovery systems, and concentrate on further refining and improving their programme outcomes. This will enable them to open up the possibility of delivering nationally certified courses while continuing to build a more sustainable and diversified funding base for the future. We can't wait to see how they get on!

Working with our longstanding partners **Aid Pioneers** (an organisation seed-funded by the Altenburg Foundation) and collaborating with **Weema**, a grassroots NGO, we will be supporting our first project in Ethiopia.

Ethiopia

This will provide much-needed solar power to Mudula High School, a critical community hub and innovative education provider established in an area highly vulnerable to the changing climate. We will keep you updated about the progress of this new initiative.

Want to know more?

To find out more about our partners and our work together, please visit:

www.weema.org
www.aidpioneers.com
www.mayankho.org

And for more details about the incredible prize won by Alsama go to:

<https://globalteacherprize.org/news/community-news/2319/2319-Announcing-the-Winner-of-the-Global-Schools-Prize->